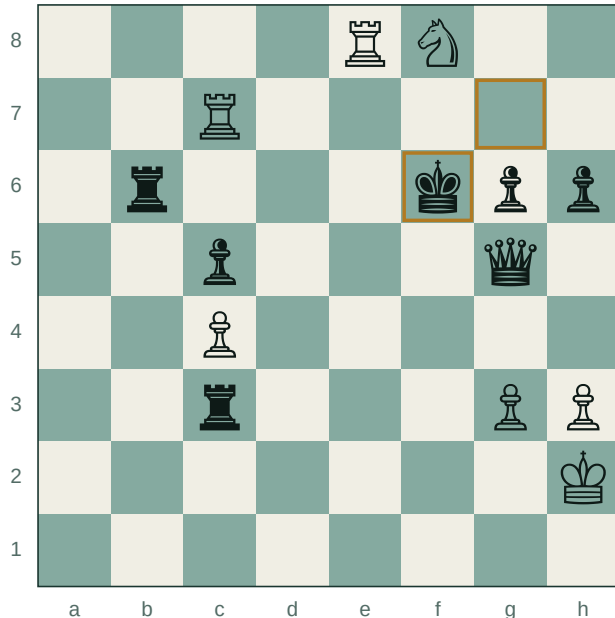


Interference tactics: White, move 40

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 39...Kf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. Nh7+ Kf5 41. Rxc5#

40.Nh7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h7 it attacks king on f6 and queen on g5. Recorded reply: **40...Kf5**.

41.Rxc5# Mate: rook on c5 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on c5. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on f6. Geometrically undefended: rook on b6 and rook on c3. Check for tactical protection.